

BARNABY BEAR'S BRIGHT BALLOONS

Story 4 — A Colorful Kids Story About Sharing



Barnaby Bear with his four super shiny balloons!

Figure 1: Barnaby Bear walking proudly through Sunny Meadow.

Page 1: The Four Bright Balloons

Once upon a time in Sunny Meadow, there lived a fluffy little bear named Barnaby. Barnaby loved bright colors more than anything else in the whole world! On his birthday, his mother gave him four big, bouncy balloons.

There was a **Red Balloon** as bright as a juicy strawberry, a **Yellow Balloon** as warm as the morning sun, a **Green Balloon** as fresh as spring grass, and a **Blue Balloon** as deep as the summer sky.

"Look at my balloons!" sang Barnaby, skipping across the green grass. "They are all mine, mine, mine! I am the happiest bear in the whole meadow!"

Barnaby held all four strings tightly in his soft paw. He did not want anyone else to touch them because he wanted to keep all the happiness for himself.

Page 2: Friends in the Meadow

As Barnaby walked near the Berry Bush, he met his little friend, Penny the Bunny. Penny looked very sad because her toy windmill had broken.

"Oh, Barnaby," whispered Penny. "Your red balloon is so pretty! May I hold it just for a little bit to make me smile?"

"No, Penny," said Barnaby, pulling his balloons closer. "If I give you one, I will have fewer balloons!"

Next, Barnaby met Pip the Squirrel sitting near an old oak tree. Pip had lost his acorns and was tired from searching all morning.

"Barnaby, your yellow balloon looks like bright sunshine! Can I hold it to warm up my paws?" asked Pip gently.

"No, Pip," replied Barnaby loudly. "These are my special balloons!"

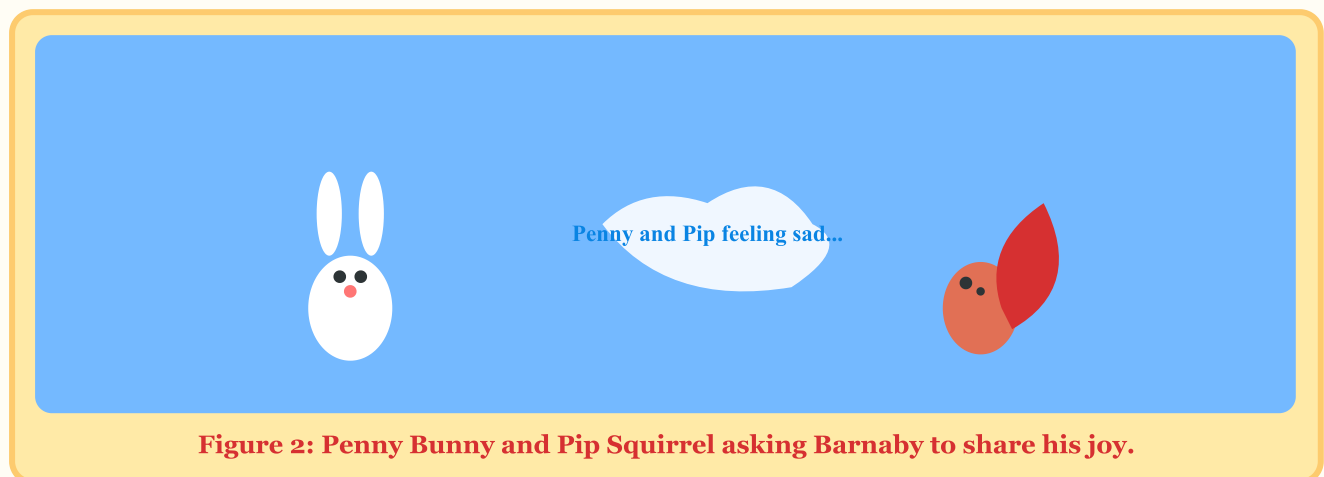


Figure 2: Penny Bunny and Pip Squirrel asking Barnaby to share his joy.

Barnaby kept walking, but strangely, his heart did not feel happy anymore. His paws felt heavy, and holding four balloons all by himself wasn't half as much fun as he thought it would be.

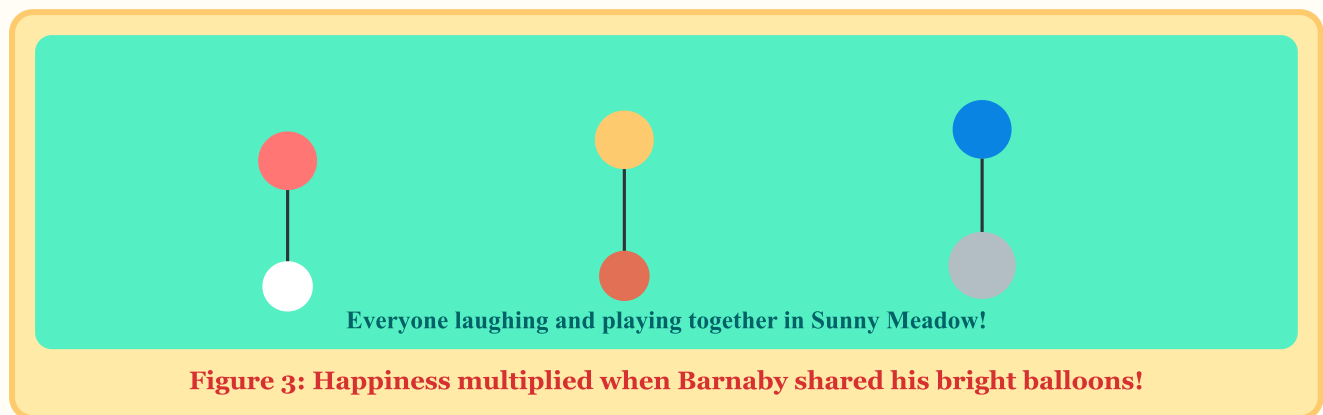
Page 3: The Magic of Sharing

Barnaby sat down near the Pond. He looked at the four bright balloons floating above him, then turned around to see Penny and Pip sitting alone, looking sad. Barnaby thought hard.

He stood up and walked back to Penny. He handed her the bright **Red Balloon**. Penny instantly giggled and hugged Barnaby tightly!

Then, Barnaby handed the **Yellow Balloon** to Pip. Pip spun around in circles with a big, bright smile!

Barnaby gave the **Green Balloon** to Ollie the Owl sitting in the tree above them, and kept the **Blue Balloon** for himself.



Suddenly, Sunny Meadow felt twice as bright! Seeing his friends smile filled Barnaby's heart with more warm joy than holding all four balloons ever did.

MORAL OF THE STORY

Sharing doubled the fun! Joy is not having everything for yourself, but sharing what you have with others.

